

Annotation Procedures for Systematic analysis of Presidential X (twitter) Accounts

The purpose of this annotation task is to annotate characteristics of an official or representative's X (former Twitter) account associated with the executive leadership of each country, including presidents, prime ministers, or monarchs. In particular, you will annotate an account in regards to its access types, activity types, account type, and account succession pattern. Your task is to [identify the **categorical values** for each of the following].

1. **Access Type:** *[Input categorical values]*
 - a. **Public account:** The account is publicly accessible, allowing any user to view content, follow the account, and interact (e.g., like, reply, repost) without restriction.
 - b. **Protected/Private account:** The account restricts access to its content, and posts are visible only to approved followers. Users must request permission to follow, and interaction is limited to authorized followers.
→ if an account is protected/private, do not code #2 and #4.
2. **Activity Type:** There are many different types of accounts based on their observable activity status on X. We define each activity type of account below. Your task is to select from **a to f** the closest status of account in a list. *[Input categorical values]*
 - a. **Active** account: The account exists and is actively posting/interacting within the recent *one year*.
 - b. **Dormant** account: The account still exists, but has not posted for more than *one year*, with no explicit indication of permanent inactivity (there is a possibility *they might come back later*)
 - c. **Archived** account: The account exists, but does not post anymore and *explicitly indicates* that it is no longer active (e.g., labeled as an “archived account” in the profile or bio).
 - d. **Posthumous** account: The account still exists, but has ceased activity due to a major status change of the account holder (e.g., death or permanent departure from public life; it is certain that *they will not come back*).
 - e. **Deactivated/Deleted** account: The account previously existed and was active, but is no longer accessible (can no longer be found) on the platform at the time of observation due to deactivation, deletion, or removal. In some cases, the account remains visible, but all content has been deleted or removed from public view.
 - f. **Locked/Suspended** account: The account is temporarily or permanently restricted by the platform (e.g., suspended, locked, or limited).

Note: Coders must verify the account holder's status using external, reliable sources when classifying an account as *posthumous*. This includes checking credible news outlets, official announcements, verified obituaries, or authoritative institutional pages.

- If **confirmed deceased or permanently departed from public life**: code as *Posthumous account*.
- If **no reliable confirmation is found**: do **not** assign *Posthumous*; instead classify based on observable account activity (e.g., *Dormant* or *Archived*).

3. **Account Type:** Social media accounts can be categorized based on whether they are anchored in the person, the political office, or the institution supporting that office. [*Input categorical values*]
- a. **Person-based account:** An account owned by and tied to an individual political leader. The account remains with the individual regardless of whether they hold office, and is not transferred to successors. It may contain both personal and official content, but its defining feature is that it follows the person across roles and over time.
→ **if an account is person-based, do not code #4.**
 - b. **Position-based account:** An account owned by a political office (e.g., president, prime minister), not the individual officeholder. The account is intended to persist across leadership transitions and is transferred or reused by successive officeholders. Its defining feature is continuity of the office, not the person.
 - c. **Institution-based account:** The holder of the account is an executive institution (e.g., presidential office, prime minister's office, royal court), not the individual officeholder; usually persists regardless of leadership change, the executive-supporting institution

Note: Code based on whether the account follows the **person** or stays with the **office across different people**, not based on who manages or posts the content.

4. **Account Succession Pattern:** Social media accounts (formally associated with an institution or office) can be categorized based on how they persist or change across transitions in officeholders. Classification is applied at the level of individual accounts (not account systems) and is based on their status at the time of observation. [*Input categorical values*]
- a. **Persistent account:** The same account persists across transitions, and its content history remains continuously available on the same account.
 - b. **Handle-persistent account:** A specific handle is associated with a particular office or position and functions as a stable identifier across officeholders. The handle persists across transitions, but its content is not carried over and is instead

reset or archived. As a result, continuity is maintained at the level of account identity (as represented by the handle), but not at the level of content.

- c. **Non-persistent account:** The account does not persist across transitions. Three examples of this type of account: (1) Each officeholder or term uses a distinct account, with no continuity in account handle and content across accounts. Content remains within each individual account. (2) Predecessor or archived accounts in handle-persistent systems, where the original shared handle is reassigned and the previous account is renamed and archived, resulting in a discontinuity in the handle. (3) Newly created institutional or position-based accounts under the current government. Previous governments do not appear to have used similar institution-based accounts, making it difficult to determine whether these accounts will persist across future transitions.

Note: In handle-persistent systems, the currently active account using the institutional handle (e.g., POTUS) is coded as Handle-persistent, while predecessor or archived accounts (e.g., POTUS44, POTUS45Archive) are coded as Non-persistent.